Freedi Platform - Feature Guide

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Freedi is an open-source platform for **scalable deliberative democracy**. It enables groups of any size to collaborate, evaluate ideas, and build consensus through continuous feedback.

The platform consists of three specialized applications, each designed for a different deliberation use case:

App	Purpose	Best For
Freedi (Main App)	Full deliberation platform	Group discussions, multi-stage decisions
Mass Consensus	Quick consensus at scale	Surveys, large audiences, anonymous feedback
Freedi Sign	Collaborative document review	Document signing, paragraph-level feedback

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1. Freedi - Main Application

The core deliberation platform where groups discuss topics, propose solutions, evaluate ideas, and reach consensus through a structured democratic process.

1.1 How It Works

Freedi follows a four-step cycle:

1. **Propose** - Participants create statements or solution options
2. **Evaluate** - Everyone rates proposals on a scale from -1 (oppose) to +1 (support)
3. **Aggregate** - The consensus algorithm calculates real-time scores
4. **Iterate** - Rankings inspire better proposals until consensus emerges

> **The Consensus Algorithm:** Freedi uses **Mean - SEM** (Standard Error of Mean) instead of simple voting. This prevents manipulation by small groups, rewards consistency, and allows new proposals to compete fairly as evaluations accumulate.

1.2 Core Features

Creating & Managing Discussions

- **Create questions** on any topic for group deliberation
- **Propose options** as potential solutions or answers
- **Hierarchical structure** - nest sub-questions, options, and comments at any depth
- **Multi-stage questions** that guide groups through: Explanation, Suggestion, First Evaluation, Second Evaluation, Voting, and Results

Evaluating & Voting

- **Continuous evaluation** on a -1 to +1 scale (not binary yes/no)
- **Real-time consensus scores** visible to all participants
- **Change your mind** - update evaluations at any time
- **Community voice evaluation** - evaluate using collective criteria

Multiple Views

Participants can switch between different ways to visualize the same data:

View	What It Shows
Chat	Threaded discussion with user avatars
Options	All proposals with evaluation scores, sortable by consensus
Agreement Map	Visual clusters showing areas of consensus and disagreement
Collaboration Index	Measures group polarization vs. unity
Mind Map	Tree visualization of the entire statement hierarchy

Groups & Rooms

- **Create groups** to organize participants
- **Room assignment** - create breakout rooms with diversity settings
- **Option joining** - participants form sub-groups around preferred options

1.3 Admin Features

Facilitation Tools

- **Follow Me** - set a navigation path that participants can follow via links
- **Power Follow Me** - automatically redirect all non-admin users to a specific view
- **Member management** - approve, ban, or promote participants
- **Visibility controls** - hide unpublished options until ready

Access Control

Mode	Description
Open	Anyone can join and participate
Registered	Participants must create an account
Moderated	Admin approves each participant
Secret	Invitation only, hidden from public

Communication

- **Email invitations** with optional PIN codes
- **In-app notifications** for new proposals and updates
- **Push notifications** (mobile and desktop)

Data & Export

- Export results in **JSON, CSV, SVG, and PNG** formats
- **Demographics collection** and filtering
- **AI-powered clustering** - automatically group similar ideas

1.4 AI-Powered Features

- **Similarity detection** - flag duplicate proposals before submission
- **Idea clustering** - AI groups related proposals for easier review
- **Proposal refinement** - AI assistance for improving proposal text

1.5 Platform Capabilities

- **6 languages** supported: English, Hebrew, Arabic, Spanish, German, Dutch, Persian
- **RTL support** - automatic right-to-left layout for Hebrew, Arabic, and Persian
- **Accessibility** - WCAG AA compliant with keyboard navigation, screen readers, and high contrast mode
- **Mobile responsive** - works on phones, tablets, and desktops
- **PWA** - installable as a progressive web app for offline access
- **Real-time** - all changes sync instantly across all participants

2. Mass Consensus App

A high-performance application designed for crowdsourced consensus building at scale. Optimized for speed, anonymous participation, and intuitive interaction through a swipe-based interface.

2.1 How It Works

1. An admin creates a question with initial solution proposals
2. Participants receive a link or QR code - **no login required**
3. Participants swipe through solutions, rating each one
4. Consensus scores calculate in real-time
5. Participants can submit their own solutions
6. Results are available immediately as votes accumulate

2.2 Core Features

Swipe-Based Evaluation

The main interaction model uses intuitive swipe gestures:

Swipe Direction	Rating	Meaning
Far left	-1.0	Strongly Disagree
Left	-0.5	Disagree
Up (center)	0.0	Neutral
Right	+0.5	Agree
Far right	+1.0	Strongly Agree

- **Visual zone indicators** with emoji feedback
- **Button-based alternative** for users who prefer clicking over swiping
- **Previous evaluation tracking** - see how you rated each solution before

Solution Submission

- **Submit new solutions** (3-500 characters)
- **Duplicate detection** - the system checks for similar existing solutions before submission
- **Character count validation** with visual feedback

Results & Tracking

- View all solutions sorted by **consensus score**
- See **participant count** and evaluation statistics
- **"My Solutions" tab** to track your submitted proposals
- Real-time score updates as new evaluations come in

Surveys (Multi-Question Flow)

Admins can link multiple questions into a complete survey experience:

- **Opening slide** with custom branding and description
- **Demographic questions** to collect participant information
- **Explanation pages** with educational content between questions
- **Progress bar** showing current position in the survey
- **Completion screen** with achievement badges

Achievement Badges

Participants earn recognition for different types of engagement:

- **Early Contributor** - among the first to evaluate
- **Thoughtful Evaluator** - evaluated many solutions
- **Solution Creator** - submitted original proposals
- **Consensus Participant** - contributed to consensus building

2.3 Admin Features

Survey Management

- Create and manage **multi-question surveys**

- Set survey status: draft, active, or closed
- **Reorder questions** with drag-and-drop
- Add **demographic pages** and **explanation pages** between questions
- Custom **opening slides** with logos and branding

Configuration

- **Language settings** - set default language or force a specific language for all participants
- **Test mode** - test the survey without affecting real results
- **Clear test data** before going live

Results & Analytics

- Real-time response statistics
- Completion rates
- Export capabilities
- Demographic breakdowns

2.4 Key Differences from Main App

Feature	Main App	Mass Consensus
Login	Required	Not required (anonymous)
Interaction	Read, comment, evaluate	Swipe to rate
Focus	Deep deliberation	Quick consensus
Structure	Hierarchical discussions	Flat solution list
Speed	Standard	Ultra-fast (< 1 second load)
Surveys	Not available	Full multi-question support
Demographics	Basic	Integrated collection
Gamification	Minimal	Achievement badges

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3. Freedi Sign

A collaborative document review and signing platform that enables crowdsourced feedback at the paragraph level. Designed for organizations that need democratic document improvement with transparent consensus building.

3.1 How It Works

1. An admin creates or uploads a document
2. The document is presented paragraph by paragraph
3. Participants can **sign**, **reject**, **comment on**, or **suggest changes** to any paragraph
4. Suggestions are voted on by all participants
5. When consensus is reached, changes can be applied (manually or automatically)
6. The document evolves through collective input

3.2 Core Features

Document Signing

- **Sign a document** to record your approval (with timestamp)
- **Reject a document** with optional feedback explaining your reasoning
- **Signature counts** displayed in real-time
- **Progress tracking** - see how many participants have signed

Paragraph-Level Suggestions

- **Propose alternative text** for any paragraph
- **Vote on suggestions** from other participants (thumbs up/down)
- **Real-time consensus percentage** for each suggestion
- **Visual progress bars** showing agreement levels
- Multiple suggestions per paragraph supported

Comments & Discussion

- **Comment on specific paragraphs** to share thoughts
- **Nested discussion threads** for in-depth conversations
- **Real-time comment counts** on each paragraph
- Full transparency - all comments are visible to participants

Heat Maps

Visual tools to understand engagement across the document:

Heat Map Mode	What It Shows
Views	Which paragraphs are most read
Support	Consensus levels across paragraphs
Importance	Which paragraphs participants consider most important

- **Color-coded paragraphs** based on engagement intensity
- **Demographic breakdowns** for targeted analysis

Version History

- View all **past versions** of each paragraph
- See **who changed what** and when
- Compare old vs. new text side by side
- Full **audit trail** of document evolution

3.3 Admin Features

Admin Dashboard

Quick overview with key metrics:

- Total participants, signatures, and rejections
- Comment and suggestion counts
- Most engaged paragraphs
- Average approval scores

Document Editor

- **Rich text editing** with a visual editor
- Add, remove, and reorder paragraphs
- Configure heading levels and paragraph types
- Heading numbering (e.g., 1.1.1)

Version Control System

The most powerful admin feature, with three modes:

Mode	How It Works
Manual	Admin reviews a queue, accepts or rejects each suggestion with optional edits
Timer	Automatic batches on a schedule with optional admin approval
Automatic	Suggestions above the consensus threshold are applied in real-time

Review queue features:

- Side-by-side comparison (current text vs. proposed change)
- Consensus score display for each suggestion
- Edit suggestions before approving
- Rejection with reason/notes
- Bulk operations (approve/reject multiple)

Customization & Settings

- **Logo and branding** upload
- **Custom header colors**
- **Table of Contents** - enable/disable, set depth level, position
- **Explanation videos** - optional intro video before document viewing
- **Feature toggles** - enable/disable comments, suggestions, voting, and importance

Privacy & Access

Setting	Description

Public	Anyone can view and interact
Private	Login required to access
Google Login Required	Force Google authentication
Hide User Identity	Anonymize participant names
Show Signature Counts	Toggle signature total visibility

Demographic Surveys

- Collect participant demographics (configurable questions)
- Make surveys optional or required
- Filter analytics by demographic data
- Export demographic data separately

Team Management

- Add and remove collaborators
- Set roles: owner, editor, viewer
- Send and manage invitations

Export & Analytics

- Export **signature data** (CSV)
- Export **engagement details** (CSV, JSON)
- Export **demographic data** separately
- **Heat map analytics** with demographic filtering

3.4 Accessibility & Language

- **6 languages** supported with automatic detection
- **RTL/LTR** automatic text direction
- **WCAG AA** compliant
- **High contrast mode** for visual accessibility
- **Enhanced visibility mode** for elderly users (larger, clearer buttons)
- **Keyboard navigation** throughout the interface
- **Accessibility widget** for quick adjustments

Feature Comparison

Feature	Freedi (Main)	Mass Consensus	Freedi Sign
User login required	Yes	No	Configurable
Continuous evaluation (-1 to +1)	Yes	Yes (5 levels)	No
Paragraph-level feedback	No	No	Yes
Document signing	No	No	Yes
Multi-stage questions	Yes	No	No
Swipe interface	No	Yes	No
Surveys	No	Yes	No
Heat maps	No	No	Yes
Version control	No	No	Yes
AI features	Yes	Partial	No
Discussion views (chat, map, etc.)	Yes	No	No
Room assignment	Yes	No	No
Follow Me facilitation	Yes	No	No
Achievement badges	No	Yes	No
Anonymous participation	No	Yes	Configurable
Push notifications	Yes	No	No
Multi-language (6+ languages)	Yes	Yes	Yes
RTL support	Yes	Yes	Yes
WCAG AA accessibility	Yes	Yes	Yes
Data export	Yes	Yes	Yes
Real-time collaboration	Yes	Yes	Yes

Mobile responsive	Yes	Yes	Yes

> **Learn more:** Visit freedi.tech for documentation, demos, and getting started guides.